

MUNA ADEN

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EDUCATION

St. Cloud State University

St. Cloud, MN | Aug 2022 - May 2026

B.S. Cybersecurity | Honors Program | Dean's List, 4 Consecutive Years

Double Minor: Political Science & International Relations

EXPERIENCE

Splunk SIEM Operator, 1st Place State Champions

Jan 2026

Collegiate Cyber Defense Competition (CCDC) | Alexandria, MN

- Deployed 59 scheduled detection alerts in minutes by writing `deploy_alerts.py` using the Splunk REST API, enabling immediate defensive coverage under live adversarial attack conditions
- Detected and escalated active red team persistence mechanisms by continuously monitoring Splunk SIEM alerts across endpoints and network systems, contributing directly to incident containment and recovery
- Triageed and communicated real time security alerts to the team by operating as the sole SIEM analyst throughout the competition, resulting in a 1st place finish at the state championship
- Competed at NCCDC Regionals representing SCSU after placing 1st at the state championship

Digital Forensics Intern

Jul 2025 - Aug 2025

Digital Forensics Now | Miami, FL

- Produced legally admissible investigation documentation by conducting forensic disk image analysis using Autopsy to identify malicious artifacts and reconstruct attack timelines, directly supporting active cases
- Detected suspicious network behavior and documented evidence for incident response by performing packet capture analysis with Wireshark, resulting in actionable findings for remediation and compliance reporting
- Maintained full chain of custody from evidence acquisition through artifact analysis across file systems, registry, logs, and memory, ensuring integrity of findings suitable for legal proceedings

PROJECTS

Splunk SIEM Homelab, Live Threat Detection | <https://github.com/muna-aden/Splunk-Siem-Homelab>

- Detected 312 failed SSH authentication attempts in real time by building a Splunk detection rule monitoring Linux auth logs, triggering an alert within minutes of a simulated Hydra brute force attack from Kali Linux
- Ingested live Windows Event Logs across Security, System, and Application sources by configuring Splunk Universal Forwarder on a Windows host forwarding to Splunk Enterprise on Oracle Linux, resulting in full log pipeline visibility
- Documented attack findings in a professional incident report by engineering 3 custom detection rules, building a SOC Overview dashboard, and mapping the attack to MITRE ATT&CK (T1110.001, T1021.004), demonstrating end to end SOC analyst workflow

AWS Cloud Security Audit, Senior Capstone

- Reduced privileged access risk across a multi service AWS environment by designing and implementing 5 scoped least privilege IAM policies with MFA enforcement across EC2, S3, and RDS, eliminating overprivileged accounts as an attack vector
- Produced CIS AWS Foundations Benchmark compliance documentation across CloudTrail, CloudWatch, and GuardDuty by leading a 5 person audit team, resulting in a quantified before and after security posture comparison presented at the Engineering and Technology Expo

Integrated Network Security & Incident Response Labs

- Identified security gaps across operating systems, networks, and endpoints by performing vulnerability scanning with Nessus and Nmap and analyzing TCP/IP, DNS, and DHCP traffic, producing findings that supported simulated SOC triage workflows
- Restored system integrity after simulated malware and ransomware incidents by executing containment, eradication, and recovery procedures and configuring firewall rules and network segmentation to reduce attack surface

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

Certifications: CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701, Active) · TestOut Ethical Hacker Pro · Cisco Junior Cybersecurity Analyst · AWS Generative AI, Udacity · Cisco Security & Connectivity Support

Security Operations: Splunk SIEM · Continuous Security Monitoring · Alert Triage & Incident Detection · Incident Response · Threat Hunting · IDS · SOC Operations · MITRE ATT&CK · Case Management

Cloud & IAM: AWS IAM · EC2 · S3 · RDS · CloudTrail · GuardDuty · Terraform IaC · CIS Benchmarks · Least Privilege · MFA · Cloud Security

Risk & Governance: NIST CSF/RMF · HIPAA · Risk Assessment · Business Impact Analysis · Security Policy Writing · SOP Development · Third Party Risk

Tools & Languages: Python · PowerShell · Bash · Ansible · Nessus · Nmap · Wireshark · Autopsy · Kali Linux · Linux · Windows · Virtualized Infrastructure · AWS